

First American pope is chosen



YARA NARDI/REUTERS

Cardinal Robert Prevost of the United States, newly elected Pope Leo XIV, greets his worldwide flock Thursday from the balcony of St. Peter's Basilica in the Vatican.

Path to papacy wound through Peru, Vatican

BY CHICO HARLAN AND EMILY WAX-THIBODEAUX

ROME — Robert Prevost broke a historical taboo against American popes with a path that was anything but typically American. Though the man now called Leo XIV is a Chicago native, he is known in Rome as the “Latin Yankee” for the decades he spent in Peru, ministering to the dispossessed and marginalized and even becoming a naturalized citizen. Until several weeks ago, he held one of the most important Vatican posts, overseeing the powerful office that vets bishops from around the world. His rise — as a multilingual American with global experience and contacts — marks an attempt by the Catholic Church to find a middle ground at a time of wide internal divisions.

SEE PREVOST ON A11



ELOISA LOPEZ/REUTERS

In St. Peter's Square, the crowd celebrates the appearance of white smoke from the Sistine Chapel's chimney, indicating the selection of a new pope. “Peace be with you all,” Leo said when he emerged.

Bells toll in U.S. as faithful grasp the ‘unbelievable’

BY KIM BELLWARE, JOANNA SLATER, DANA MUNRO AND MICHELLE BOORSTEIN

CHICAGO — John McGreevy struggled at first to find the words to express his amazement. “Unbelievable,” said McGreevy, a prominent historian of Catholicism at the University of Notre Dame, minutes after Chicago native Robert Prevost was announced as the next pope. “This is stuff you wouldn’t have ever thought would happen. An American pope. Amazing.” For millions of U.S. Catholics, Thursday’s elevation of an American to the papacy was a source of joy and surprise, something that had not seemed possible — until suddenly it was. Many experts said that the dominance of the United States

SEE REACTION ON A10

CHICAGO NATIVE SIGNALS CONTINUITY

Leo XIV solidifies shift in power away from Europe

BY ANTHONY FAIOLA, MICHELLE BOORSTEIN AND STEFANO PITRELLI

VATICAN CITY — As the sun set Thursday over St. Peter’s Basilica, a 69-year-old prelate who began his calling as a Chicago altar boy stepped onto the central balcony as the first American pope, stunning Vatican City and the world by breaking the long-standing taboo of electing the son of a global superpower to lead the Catholic Church. Naming himself Pope Leo XIV, a title that nods to the social teachings of the church, the man born Robert Prevost began what could be a long, new chapter in a divided faith. From the balcony, Leo acknowledged the late Francis, a patron who had elevated him, from a priest who spent two decades as a missionary in Peru to one of the powerful positions in the Vatican, where he oversaw the promotion of the church’s hierarchy.

The election of a first North American pontiff came immediately after the death of the first Latin American pope, and it signaled a certain relinquishing of papal authority from Europe, the continent whose popes had dominated the ancient and modern church, and a region where the faith is now flagging. Accusations that Leo, when serving in Peru and the United States, mishandled or failed to act on sexual abuse could lead to further challenges in countries like Germany, where hundreds of thousands have fled the pews in disgust over the mishandling of such cases by the church. Also in question is how completely the Global South, where the Catholic Church is growing the fastest and where some countries harbor skeptical views of the United States, will embrace the new pope. But during his time in Peru, Leo became a dual citizen, and some Latin Americans were quick to claim him as an adopted son. Leo’s positions on many of the hot-button issues separating traditionalists from reformers are less than clear. More than a decade ago, he indicated distaste for the normalization of homosexuality in pop culture and has shown skepticism on the notion of ordaining women as deacons. But, from the balcony, he signaled a certain measure of continuity with Francis, who challenged norms, embraced migrants and the poor and sought to

SEE POPE ON A9

Holy names: Leo XIV joins popes concerned with social justice. **A10**

Martin out as U.S. attorney, to be replaced by Fox host

BY SPENCER S. HSU, PATRICK SVITEK AND KEITH L. ALEXANDER

President Donald Trump on Thursday named Fox News host Jeanine Pirro to take over as interim U.S. attorney for D.C., replacing embattled nominee Ed Martin after 15 tumultuous weeks in office marked by his threats to investigate Trump’s perceived political adversaries and firings and demotions of career prosecutors who handled cases involving the president and the Jan. 6, 2021, U.S. Capitol attack. Pirro, 73, a former judge in Westchester County, New York, who served as elected prosecutor

from 1993 until 2005, has been one of Trump’s most reliable backers in Fox News’s stable of conservative commentators. Announcing the move on social media, Trump called Pirro “a powerful crusader for victims of crime.” He added, “Jeanine is incredibly well qualified for this position, and is considered one of the Top District Attorneys in the History of the State of New York.” Pirro will take over for Martin, 55, an ardent Trump loyalist, before his 120-day interim appointment ends May 20.

SEE MARTIN ON A6

@PKCapitol: Why Sen. Tillis was prepared to tank nomination. **A2**

U.S., Britain reach trade pact in first agreement on tariffs

BY JEFF STEIN, NATALIE ALLISON AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

President Donald Trump on Thursday announced a new trade pact with Britain that he touted as likely to be just the first of many agreements with countries around the world, as the administration races to mitigate the damage from its global trade war. Joined in the Oval Office by several of his top advisers and the new British ambassador to Washington, Trump praised the deal and said it would lower trade restrictions for U.S. exporters while bringing the two countries into closer economic alignment.

Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick and other administration officials said the deal would create \$5 billion in economic opportunities for U.S. exports, saying Britain had agreed to step up purchases of ethanol, beef, planes and other products while lowering tariffs and other domestic restrictions. Trump said the 10 percent minimum tariff he applied to all countries would remain in effect on Britain, but that certain British exports — such as automobiles — would be spared higher tariffs. Jet engines and

SEE TRADE ON A16

E.U. threatens tariffs: Auto parts, aircraft eyed amid U.S. talks. **A16**

President wants higher taxes on the wealthy in budget bill

BY JACOB BOGAGE AND JEFF STEIN

President Donald Trump instructed congressional Republicans this week to raise taxes on the wealthiest earners as part of his “big, beautiful bill,” rattling his party’s brittle consensus on economic issues and muddling the GOP’s path toward enacting his campaign promises. Congress is working to extend lower rates for individuals from Trump’s 2017 Tax Cuts and Jobs Act that are set to expire at the end of this year. Trump, in recent conversation with House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana), said Congress should raise taxes on

some of the highest earners, according to two people familiar with the president’s position who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they weren’t authorized to discuss the issue publicly. Administration officials have discussed several options for doing so, including allowing the top tax rate to revert back to Obama-era levels. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has also floated creating a tax bracket for those earning more than \$5 million per year.

SEE TAX ON A7

SALT: GOP is at loggerheads over state and local tax deduction. **A14**

IN THE NEWS

Confusion aloft As the Trump administration spends billions to upgrade the air traffic control system, the FAA is dealing with a leadership exodus and demoralized staff. **A15**
Majority support for project A poll showed that 55 percent of D.C. residents favor using \$850 million for a Commanders stadium. **B1**

THE NATION Trump officials lauded Columbia University’s handling of protests that resulted in 80 arrests. **A3**
The attorney general in New York who targeted Trump is now under DOJ investigation. **A20**

THE WORLD Archrivals India and Pakistan accused each other of carrying out further hostile acts. **A8**
In wartime Russia, schools are preparing the next generation of fighters. **A12**

THE ECONOMY A new bill would impose restrictions on the Transportation Security Administration’s use of facial recognition. **A14**
Microsoft’s Bill Gates accelerated plans to give away most of his wealth and said his foundation will close by the end of 2045. **A15**

THE REGION A federal judge sentenced a Virginia man to more than 30 years in prison for funding the Islamic State. **B1**
A nonverbal and autistic artist who paints and taps out poems will have his work displayed at a D.C. gallery this month. **B1**

SPORTS The Capitals rally to even their second-round playoff series vs. Carolina, never trailing en route to a 3-1 win at home in Game 2. **D1**
WEEKEND Six of the best spots for alfresco dining. Soak in the sun and scenery at these picturesque patios.

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54211

